Exercise 0: Preparation

Objective

Create a Snowflake trial account, log in to Snowsight, and locate your **account identifier**. This is the prerequisite for all subsequent exercises.

By the end you should have:

- [ ] A Snowflake trial account (active, logged in)
- [ ] Your **account identifier** written down somewhere you can find it later
- [ ] Basic familiarity with the Snowsight UI
- [ ] A worksheet open and ready for Exercise 1

Prerequisites

- A web browser (Chrome, Firefox, or Edge recommended)
- An email address you can check during class (for verification)
- A credit card is required for signup (as fraud check — **no charges**)

> ***No credit card?*** *Share an account with a classmate. The trial supports multiple concurrent sessions. Coordinate with your partner which of you will sign up and share the credentials.*

Step 1: Sign up for a Snowflake trial

1. Open a new browser tab and go to: https://signup.snowflake.com/
2. Fill in the form:
   - **First Name / Last Name**: your real name
   - **Email**: your email (you will need to verify it in a minute)
   - **Company**: write `BTS Student`
   - **Role**: select any (e.g., `Data Engineer`)
   - **Country**: `Spain`
3. Click **CONTINUE**.
4. On the next page:
   - **Snowflake Edition**: select **Enterprise** (the trial is free regardless of edition)
   - **Cloud Provider**: select **Amazon Web Services (AWS)**
   - **Region**: select **EU (Ireland)** or **EU (Frankfurt)** (pick the one closest to you)
   - Check the terms acceptance box
5. Click **GET STARTED**.
6. Enter your credit card details when prompted. This is a fraud-prevention check — **no charges will be made**.
7. Check your email. You will receive a verification email within a minute. If you do not see it, check your spam folder.
8. Click the **ACTIVATE** link in the email. You will be prompted to create a username and password — pick something you will remember.

> ***Important**: write down your username and password. You will need them in Exercise 4 for the dbt connection.*

Step 2: Log in to Snowsight

What is Snowsight?

Snowsight is Snowflake's web-based interface — the UI you see in your browser. It is your primary way of interacting with Snowflake:

- Write and run SQL queries (in **worksheets**)
- Browse databases, schemas and tables
- Manage warehouses, users and roles
- Monitor query history and performance
- View dashboards and charts

If you have used **pgAdmin** for PostgreSQL or **MongoDB Compass** for MongoDB, Snowsight fills the same role — but it runs in the browser (no install needed) and is the **official** Snowflake UI, not a third-party tool.

In this course, everything you do with Snowflake happens either in Snowsight (browser) or through dbt (terminal, in Exercise 4). There is no separate desktop client.

Your Snowsight URL

After activation, you are redirected to Snowsight automatically. The URL has this shape:

```
https://app.snowflake.com/<organization>/<account>/#/homepage
```

Where:

- `<organization>` is your **organization name** (a short random string assigned at signup)
- `<account>` is your **account name** (another short random string)

Both are specific to your trial. Bookmark your URL — it is your Snowflake home for the rest of the session.

Step 3: Tour of Snowsight (2 minutes)

Take a moment to explore the interface. You do not need to change anything yet — just locate each area so you know where to click during the exercises.

Area	Where to find it	What it does
Worksheets	Left panel > Projects > Worksheets	Where you write and run SQL
Databases	Left panel > Data > Databases	Browse databases, schemas, tables
Warehouses	Left panel > Admin > Warehouses	Manage compute resources
Users & Roles	Left panel > Admin > Users & Roles	Manage users and RBAC
Query History	Left panel > Monitoring > Query History	See all past queries with timing

On the top-right of any worksheet, you will see context selectors for:

- **Role** (e.g., `ACCOUNTADMIN`) — which role is currently active
- **Warehouse** (e.g., `COMPUTE_WH`) — which warehouse will execute the query
- **Database.Schema** — the default namespace for unqualified objects

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Step 4: Open a worksheet

1. In the top of the Snowsight page, click the **+** icon to open the "create" menu, then select **SQL File**.
2. A new SQL editor opens in a new tab.
3. Run your first query by pasting this and clicking the **blue Run button** (or pressing `Cmd+Return` on macOS / `Ctrl+Return` on Windows/Linux):

```
SELECT CURRENT_VERSION(), CURRENT_USER(), CURRENT_ROLE();
```

You should see a result row with:

- **CURRENT_VERSION()**: the Snowflake version (e.g., `9.x.x`)
- **CURRENT_USER()**: your username
- **CURRENT_ROLE()**: `ACCOUNTADMIN` (default role on trial accounts)

Step 5: Find your account identifier (CRITICAL for Exercise 4)

Your **account identifier** is what dbt will use to connect in Exercise 4.

From the Snowsight URL (recommended)

Look at your browser URL while in Snowsight. It has this shape:

```
https://app.snowflake.com/<organization>/<account>/#/...
```

Your account identifier is `<organization>` and `<account>` joined by a dash:

```
<organization>-<account>
```

For example, if the URL were `https://app.snowflake.com/abc1234/xy56789/#/homepage`, the account identifier would be `abc1234-xy56789`.

> *The values in your URL are unique to your trial and are different from those of your classmates.*

Verify with a SQL query (optional)

In the worksheet, run:

```
SELECT
    CURRENT_ORGANIZATION_NAME() AS org,
    CURRENT_ACCOUNT_NAME()      AS account,
    CURRENT_ORGANIZATION_NAME() || '-' || CURRENT_ACCOUNT_NAME() AS
account_identifier;
```

The `account_identifier` column should match what you read from the URL (Snowflake sometimes returns it uppercase — both cases work for dbt).

> ***Write down your account identifier now** — you will need it in Exercise 4. Save it to a note, a sticky, or the top of a worksheet as a comment.*

Step 6: Final checklist

Before moving on to Exercise 1, verify all of these are true:

- ☐ You can log in to Snowsight without issues
- ☐ You see `ACCOUNTADMIN` as your active role (top-right of worksheet)
- ☐ You can run a SELECT and see a result
- ☐ You have your **account identifier** written down
- ☐ You have your **username** and **password** written down

If any box is unchecked, raise your hand — do not continue until you have completed this exercise.

Troubleshooting

"Signup page asks for credit card"

The trial is free but Snowflake requires a credit card as fraud prevention. No charges are made. If you do not have an international credit card, share an account with a classmate.

"Verification email does not arrive"

Check spam. If still nothing after 5 minutes, try signing up again with a different email provider (Gmail tends to be reliable).

"I cannot find my account identifier"

Run the SQL query from Step 5, Option B. If that also fails (e.g., the query times out), share a screen with the instructor.

"Snowsight is very slow"

The classroom network may be overloaded. Wait a few seconds between clicks. If it remains unusable, share a session with a classmate.

What's next

Once the checklist is complete, move on to Exercise 1 (Snowflake Setup). Keep Snowsight open in one tab — you will use it throughout the remaining exercises.